

Graphics

4.1 Create a 3d Model

There are a bunch of free 3D modelling tools out there, including Blender and Wings 3D. However, if you are a beginner, these software are a little complicated to start with. A much easier option, that gives dramatic results to beginners is Bryce 3D. Bryce was owned by Corel at one point of time, and was a commercial software. The software was brought over by DAZ Studios, and has been freeware ever since. You will have to register the software. To do this, go to www.daz3d.com.

When starting with 3D modelling, don't aim for very complicated models. Start with something simple such as a watch or a building. Even going through with a simple object can be demanding in terms of time, so be prepared to spend a lot of time on your model. Once you open up Bryce, you will be presented with a very simple but powerful interface. By default, the scene will contain a camera, a ground and a default setting for the sky. Before we start modeling, its a good idea to familiarise oneself with the interface.

The view changer (1) selects the views of the scene. This is the perspective with which a user can model software. There are six directional views available, a director view, and a camera view. The directional views can be useful to carefully align elements of a model together. The controls for shifting the view (2) shifts the point of view along the three axes. These should be used only in the camera and the director modes. The banking and field of view controls (3) are used for tilting the scene, or zooming in and out of the object or elements being modelled. The trackball (4) allows for free movement around the scene. The trackball will be repeatedly used while modelling to change the point of view by slight degrees for different perspectives on the model. The rendering menu (5) will be used for the final output image after the model is ready, and offers a number of options. You can enable or disable textures, change the resolution of the image, render a quick preview or change